

D.J. PARIS

TWO OUT OF THREE SELLERS NEVER ASK.

The ones who do get a lower rate almost every time.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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**NINETY-THREE
PERCENT OF
SELLERS WHO ASK
FOR A LOWER
COMMISSION GET
ONE.**

Only one in three ever ask. The other two thirds just pay full rate and never find out.

THE AWKWARD PART ISN'T THE NUMBER. IT'S WHO BRINGS IT UP FIRST.

A 2026 Clever Real Estate survey of home sellers found that just one in three who used an agent ever tried to negotiate the commission, but 93 percent of the ones who asked got a reduction. Most agents wait for that question and get defensive when it lands. The agents who don't lose the conversation never make the seller work up the nerve to ask. They bring the fee up themselves, in the same breath as what it buys.

WHAT CHANGES AT YOUR NEXT LISTING APPOINTMENT:

1 Stop waiting for the ask.

Bring your fee up yourself, in the same sentence where you explain what it buys the seller.

2 Trade defense for plain math.

If they ask "is that negotiable," don't retreat. State exactly what's included at that rate and let them decide.

3 Watch which sellers refer you.

The ones who never had to ask are the ones who come back. The ones who had to fight for a number remember the fight, not the deal.

THE TAKEAWAY

YOU DON'T LOSE SELLERS OVER YOUR RATE.

You lose them to whichever agent brought it up first.